How Clear Is Your Picture of What's Going Wrong With Your Father's Care?

Twelve questions about what you know so far. At the end: the problems you can already describe, the ones that are still a feeling, and who to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your picture is. It doesn't measure your father, your sister or anyone's effort, and no answer here means he is unsafe or needs a particular kind of care.

1. Have you written down the main concerns people have raised about your father's care, in the words they used?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. For each concern, do you have one specific example of what happened, and when?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Have you heard from your father, in his own words, what concerns him about how things are going?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know what has to happen for him in a normal week, and who is supposed to do each thing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know which of those tasks are not getting done at the moment?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. For each concern, do you know what was different in your father's day because of it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Have you asked your sister, who does most of the day-to-day, what has to change right away?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Do you know everything she does for him in a week, including the parts the rest of the family doesn't see?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Where family members describe the same event differently, have you written down each account?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Do you know which decisions are coming up, and when each is due?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. For each concern the family can't settle itself, do you know who you'd take it to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Does each concern you want to deal with first have a next action and a name beside it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know, not how your father is doing or how well anyone is looking after him. A low count means there are things to find out, and most of them are one conversation away.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which problems you can already describe and which are still a feeling. Keep the page you just copied beside you: the care interview asks about your father's situation area by area, including the parts nobody has raised yet, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›